Geelong Arts Centre Child Safe Code of Conduct

Purpose

The purpose of Geelong Arts Centre's Child Safe Code of Conduct (the Code) as part of the internal Child Safety and Wellbeing Framework is to ensure the Geelong Arts Centre (the Centre) complies with the *Working with Children Act 2005* and the *Child Safe Standards 2022.*

The Centre provides an open, safe, and friendly environment for all children. This Code outlines appropriate standards of behaviour by adults toward children.

The Code aims to protect children and reduce any possibility for abuse, or harm to occur. It provides guidance to workplace participants on how best to support children and prevent or better manage difficult situations.

Scope

All workplace participants are required to comply with of the Code. This includes any adult person (over the age of 18) engaged by the Centre that may work directly with or around children at any time including, but not limited to:

- employees (permanent and casual): leadership and management roles, administration, education instructors and youth workshop facilitators, production, and venue personnel (actors, stage management, chaperones, technical crew, ushers, etc.)
- venue hirers/licensees or any other adult using the Centre's venues, facilities or spaces.
- volunteers including Trust and Subcommittee members.
- contractors and sub-contractors.
- work experience students/interns/secondments.
- any other individual in the organisation that may work with or come into contact with children.
- A child includes children and young people up to the age of 18 (unless otherwise specified).

Code

Geelong Arts Centre workplace participants who work with and/or come into contact with children in their role are the Centre are responsible for promoting the safety and well-being of children and must:

- adhere to our Child Safety and Wellbeing policies and procedures.
- take all reasonable steps to protect children from any form of child abuse.
- treat all children with dignity, equality, and respect.
- pay particular attention to the needs of First Nations children and young people.
- promote the cultural safety of First Nations children and of children from culturally and linguistically diverse backgrounds.
- promote the safety of d/Deaf and Disabled children.
- promote the safety of children who identify with a diverse gender and/or sexuality.
- promote the safety of children who have disadvantaged social and/or economic backgrounds.
- listen to and value the ideas and opinions of children; especially on issues that are important to them or about decisions that affect their lives.
- act as a positive role model for healthy relationships when engaging with others, especially with children.
- Promote and uphold the standards of positive behaviour – such as friendship, teamwork, and honesty – to ensure children and young people are aware of what is and is not appropriate.

- develop positive relationships with children and parents (including carers and legal guardians) based on mutual trust and open communication.
- be professional in your actions through your use of language, presentation, and manner.
- respect the privacy of children and parents (including carers and legal guardians), and only disclose information to people who have a need to know.
- be aware of risks with communication and behaviour between employees and children (including online and mobile).
- be aware of risks with communication and behaviour between children (including online and mobile).
- aim to ensure children understand they are valued members of the production, program, audience, or other experience.
- acknowledge the uniqueness and potential of all children, in recognition that enjoying their childhood without undue pressure is important.
- if by chance any children are found unsupervised, direct and accompany children to their supervisor or relevant management immediately.
- ensure effective processes are in place to respond to and report allegations of child abuse.
- continuously improve responses to any allegations of child abuse.
- report any breaches of these standards of behaviour to the Centre's Child Safety Officer or relevant management promptly.

Geelong Arts Centre workplace participants who work with and/or come into contact with children in their role are the Centre are responsible for promoting the safety and well-being of children and MUST NOT:

- discriminate against any child because of age, gender (including gender diverse or non-binary status), cultural background, religion, vulnerability, disability or sexuality.
- engage in behaviour that is intended to shame, humiliate, oppress, belittle, or degrade children.
- engage in any activity with a child that is likely to harm them physically or emotionally.
- take photos or video of children without the explicit permission of the child (if 15 years of age or older) and their parent, carer or legal guardian and relevant Centre management.
- share personal information or photos of children on social media without the informed consent of the child (if 15 years of age or older) and parent, carer or legal guardian, and relevant management.
- work with children while under the influence of alcohol or illicit drugs.
- allow any person under the age of 18 to be served or consume alcohol including via the secondary supply of liquor.
- allow any person under the age of 18 behind the bar under any circumstances.
- ignore or disregard any concerns, suspicions, or disclosures of child abuse.
- show overly familiar physical affection towards children or any unnecessary physical contact with children.
- marginalise or exclude specific children.
- show favouritism towards specific children such as the offering of gifts, special thanks, special treatment or inappropriate attention.

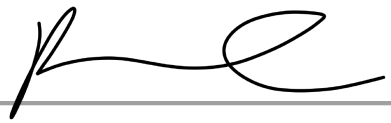
- subject children to any form of physical punishment, social isolation, immobilisation, or any other conduct likely to humiliate or frighten children.
- enter children's dressing rooms (unless you are a designated supervisor, or approved to do so by a supervisor or relevant management)
- allow children to enter an adult's dressing room or crew areas, unless accompanied by their supervisor and approval has been granted by those in the dressing room.
- close doors in rooms where children are present unless children need privacy to dress.
- allow children to (un)dress with others around, (un)dressing should take place in private.
- do things of a personal nature for children that they are able to do for themselves, such as assisting with going to the toilet or dressing.
- gossip in the presence of children.
- distress a child for the purpose of eliciting a dramatic reaction.
- develop any 'special' relationships with children outside of the professional relationship or arrange contact with children outside of work obligations.
- have unauthorised contact with children online or by phone.

Complaints about a breach of this Code of Conduct must be reported to our Child Safety Officer, Manager Governance. Contact mobile: 0405 312 446, landline: 03 5225 1216 or via email: governance@geelongartscentre.org.au

Breaches of this Code may be reported to the Victorian Police or to the Commission for Children and Young People or both. Geelong Arts Centre workplace participants who breach the Code may also be subject to disciplinary action in accordance with the Centre's Child Safety and Wellbeing Policy. This can include increased supervision, appointment to an alternative role, suspension, termination of employment or termination of a supplier/consultant Agreement with the Centre.

Our Child Safe Complaints and Reporting Procedure provides more information about our reporting obligations to external authorities as well as describing protections and confidentiality provisions for anyone making a report. The policy can also be found by asking at the Box Office (located at 81 Ryrie Street Geelong) and is also available on the Centre's website and intranet.

Please indicate your agreement in complying with the Code by signing below.

Signature 

Full Name David Greenwood OAM

Date 24.09.2026